MASKINHALLEN · USER MANUAL · VERSION 2.0

KULVERT

BASEMENT TUNNEL · ROOM FOR DRUMS · SUB STAYS MONO

A narrow concrete tunnel under the floor. Hits go in dry and come back damp, hollow and dragging, and the sub never moves.



VST3 · AU · LV2 · STANDALONE

MASKINHALLEN

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01 WELCOME

A narrow concrete tunnel under the floor. Hits go in dry and come back damp, hollow and dragging, and the sub never moves an inch.

KULVERT is a room effect for minimal techno, built for the drum bus or a send after BETONG, FASFEL, GLAPP and GRUND. It is not a hall reverb: it is a tunnel, with four prime-length tubes, wet walls and a vacuum that sucks the room back after every hit. KULVERT 2 brings the tunnel to life: trains, drips, side passages, grates, fans, flickering lights.

SWEDISH LABELS

`Längd / Diameter`	Length / Diameter	`Kondens`	Condensation (wet walls)
`Vakuum / Insug`	Vacuum / Intake	`Sirap / Synk`	Syrup / Sync
`Rost / Skarv / Blandning`	Rust / Split / Mix	`Nivå`	Level
`Vandra / Tåget / Droppar`	Wander / The train / Drips	`Sidogångar / Galler`	Side passages / Grate
`Fläkt / Lampor`	Fan / Lights	`Spola / Frys`	Rewind / Freeze

THE WINDOW



02 INSTALL

Unzip the file for your system. You get a folder called **KULVERT** (on Mac and Windows: KULVERT-macOS and KULVERT-Windows). Then run the installer for your system and restart your DAW (or rescan plug-ins). KULVERT shows up as an audio effect.

MACOS

1. Double-click `KULVERT-macOS.zip` in Downloads.
2. Open Terminal and run:
   `bash ~/Downloads/KULVERT-macOS/installera.command`
3. Quit your DAW completely and start it again.

VST3, AU and a standalone app. macOS 11 or newer, Intel or Apple Silicon. The installer copies the plug-ins and removes macOS's block on downloaded plug-ins.

WINDOWS

1. Right-click `KULVERT-Windows.zip` and choose **Extract all**.
2. Open the `KULVERT-Windows` folder and right-click `installera.bat` → **Run as administrator**.
3. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC": **More info** → **Run anyway**.

VST3 (in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3) and a standalone .exe. 64-bit Windows 10 or 11.

LINUX

1. Unzip `KULVERT-Linux.zip`.
2. Run `bash ~/Downloads/KULVERT/installera-linux.sh`. It copies the plug-ins to `~/.vst3` and `~/.lv2`.
3. Rescan plug-ins in your DAW (Bitwig, Reaper, Ardour and others).

VST3 and LV2, 64-bit x86 Linux (built on Ubuntu 22.04).

> SWEDISH OR ENGLISH
>
> The machines have Swedish names on the panel. One click on `SV | EN` in the header switches labels, menus and tooltips to English. Your choice is remembered for every MASKINHALLEN machine.

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03 UNLOCK WITH YOUR KEY

Your purchase comes with a licence key: four groups of four characters, like `XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX`. You find it in the Payhip email and on your receipt.

1. Open KULVERT. Until it is unlocked, the window shows **UNLOCK KULVERT**.
2. Paste the whole key in the field and press `UNLOCK`.
3. Done. You only need to do this once per computer: every MASKINHALLEN machine on the computer finds the key. A bundle key unlocks every machine.

The key is not case sensitive, and I/L and O/0 are treated as the same character, so a typo there does not matter. If it says the key does not work, check that the whole key was pasted. You can use your key on your own computers.

THE FREE DEMO

Every machine has a free demo with the same sound engine. Some presets and functions are locked, and the demo has its own name (KULVERT DEMO), so it can sit next to the full version. Buying the full version is what unlocks everything; install it and paste your key.

UPDATES

Updates are free for life. Download the new zip from your Payhip receipt link and run the installer again. Your projects and your key are kept.

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04 YOUR FIRST MINUTE

1. Put KULVERT on your drum bus (or on a send) and press play.
2. Start from a preset in RÖR, SCHAKT, SUG, LÄCKA or LIV.
3. Turn `BLANDNING` (mix) to taste. Up to 50 % the dry signal stays at full level.
4. Turn `VAKUUM` up for the room to duck under every hit and suck back in.
5. Open the tunnel's life: let a train pass every few bars, add drips in your key.

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05 THE SIGNAL PATH

The input is split at 150 Hz (MONO-GRIP). Everything below is summed to mono and goes straight to the output, never touched. That is the sub anchor: the kick and sub stay 100 % mono and dry however wet KULVERT gets. Everything above goes through SKARV (left/right offset), the TUNNEL (four tubes), SIRAP, ROST and the vacuum, and is mixed back in with BLANDNING.

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06 TUNNEL, TRYCK AND SUBSTANS

TUNNEL (THE ROOM)

`LÄNGD`	5–85 ms. Tunnel length: scales all four tubes together.
`DIAMETER`	150–600 Hz. The tube's resonance: low = a big pressure tunnel, high = a narrow hollow pipe.

KONDENS	0–100 %. Wet walls: more is a darker, shorter tail.

TRYCK (PRESSURE)

VAKUUM	How much the wet signal is ducked when a hit comes in.
INSUG	10–500 ms. How fast the room sucks back in after the hit: it stays down, then rushes back.
SYNK	FRI, 1/32, 1/16, 1/8, 1/4. Locks INSUG to the tempo. FRI uses the knob.
SIRAP	0–40 ms. Delays only the 300–800 Hz band of the wet signal, so knocks stretch into a rubbery thwump.

SUBSTANS (CHARACTER)

ROST	Asymmetric saturation on the wet signal only.
SKARV	Stereo split: up to 13 ms left and 19 ms right before the tunnel.
BLANDNING	Dry/wet. The dry signal stays at full level up to 50 %; the wet signal reaches full at 50 %. Below 150 Hz is never affected.
NIVÅ	−24 to +6 dB output, with a soft limiter above −1 dBFS.

Every section has a dice. ROLL rolls all three, NUDGE moves every knob a little.

07 KULVERT 2: THE TUNNEL'S LIFE

A new card under the three old ones. Everything at zero sounds exactly like KULVERT 1.

VANDRA	Wander: where in the tunnel you stand, from the mouth to deep inside.
TÅGET	The train: thunders past every 1/2/4/8 bars, with Doppler sweep and wheels.
DROPPAR	Drips: water drops in your chosen key (minor pentatonic), in time, echoing in the tunnel.
SIDOGÅNGAR	Side passages: echoes from openings, a dotted eighth left and a quarter right.
GALLER	Grate: a comb filter that changes step every eighth.
FLÄKT	Fan: the ventilation chops the room slowly and hisses.
LAMPOR	Lights: fluorescent tubes flickering in time.
SPOLA	Rewind: the last hit's tail reversed into the next one.
FRYS	Freeze: the tail hangs, nothing new comes in.

The tunnel picture lives: headlights when the train comes, flickering tubes, rings on the water when it drips and ice when the tunnel is frozen.

08 PRESETS

50 presets: RÖR, SCHAKT, SUG and LÄCKA (ten each) plus ten in LIV for the tunnel's life.

09 TROUBLESHOOTING

KULVERT does not show up	Quit the DAW completely and start it again, or rescan plug-ins. On Mac, run the installer again: it removes macOS's quarantine on the plug-in. On Windows, check that `KULVERT.vst3` is in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3.
macOS says the plug-in is damaged	That is macOS's block on downloaded files. Run `bash ~/Downloads/KULVERT-macOS/installera.command` again.
Windows protected your PC	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The plug-ins are not signed with a paid certificate.
The key does not work	Paste the whole key, including the dashes. A key for one machine only unlocks that machine; a bundle key unlocks all.
No sound	Press play in the DAW: the machines follow the transport. Instruments go on an instrument track, effects on an audio track or bus.

Anything else? Ask through the store, and the person who built the machine answers.

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